MODULE 02 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

AI Fluency: the 4D Framework

Delegation, Description, Discernment and Diligence: Anthropic's own language for using AI well.

FRAMEWORK AI Fluency USED IN D1 D2 D4 D6 D7 MODULE 2 of 33

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AI fluency is working with AI in ways that are **effective, efficient, ethical and safe**.

Where the framework comes from

- **Rick Dakan and Joseph Feller, with Anthropic**, 2025. Openly licensed.
- **Taught in Anthropic Academy's free course**, AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations.
- **Not named in the CCAO-F exam guide**, but practice questions use it by name.
- **Those questions turn on the definitions.** Know each D and its three parts precisely.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Treat 4D as supporting material: a lens on the blueprint, not a domain of its own.

Four Ds, or hiring a builder

COMPETENCY	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	WITH A BUILDER, IT IS
Delegation	Should AI do this, and which part?	What you hire them for
Description	Have I said clearly what I want?	The brief and drawings
Discernment	Is what came back any good?	Inspecting the work
Diligence	Can I stand behind it?	Sign-off, owning the result

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Delegate, describe, discern, take responsibility. In that order, most of the time.

Delegation: deciding whether, when and how

PART	WHAT IT MEANS
Problem awareness	Understand your goal and the work before involving AI
Platform awareness	Know what different AI systems can and cannot do
Task delegation	Split the work so humans and AI each do what they do best

USE IT LIKE THIS

Practical tests: how costly is an error, can it be undone, does it need human judgement or accountability?

Description: saying what you want

PART	WHAT IT DESCRIBES	HALDEN EXAMPLE
Product	The output: format, audience, style	A 300-word newsletter item
Process	How to approach the task	Summarise, then list actions
Performance	How Claude behaves with you	Challenge my weak ideas

THE TIEBREAKER

Product is what you get. Process is how it is made. Performance is how Claude works with you.

Discernment: judging what comes back

PART	WHAT IT JUDGES	ASK YOURSELF
Product	The output's quality	Accurate, relevant, coherent?
Process	How Claude got there	Any leaps or faulty logic?
Performance	How Claude behaved	Did its style help me?

ON THE EXAM

Discernment mirrors Description: the same three parts, seen from the other side.

Diligence: taking responsibility

PART	WHAT IT MEANS
Creation diligence	Choose AI systems and ways of working thoughtfully
Transparency diligence	Be honest about AI's role with everyone who needs to know
Deployment diligence	Verify and vouch for any output you use or share

ON THE EXAM

The output is yours the moment you send it. "Claude wrote it" is not a defence.

The Description-Discernment loop

01
Describe
Product, process, performance.

02
Claude responds
A draft, an answer, a plan.

03
Discern
Judge product, process, performance.

04
Refine
Describe the weak part better.

ON THE EXAM

Every weakness you discern tells you exactly which part of your description to improve.

Discernment or Diligence?

DISCERNMENT

Judging the work

- Is it accurate and complete?
- Does the reasoning hold up?
- Is it right for this audience?
- Did Claude's style help?

DILIGENCE

Answering for the work

- Have I verified what I vouch for?
- Who needs to know AI helped?
- Was this the right tool and data?
- Am I ready to own the outcome?

THE TIEBREAKER

Judging quality is Discernment. Owning the consequences is Diligence.

Three ways to work with AI

MODE	WHAT IT IS	HALDEN EXAMPLE
Automation	AI does a set task to set instructions	Reformat 40 addresses as a table
Augmentation	AI as a thinking partner, back and forth	Shaping a bid strategy together
Agency	AI set up to act for you, on its own	A policy Project supervisors ask

ON THE EXAM

In agency, you shape the AI's knowledge and behaviour, not each action it takes.

Where each D shows up on the exam

COMPETENCY	WHERE YOU MEET IT
Delegation	D4 use cases and integration; D6 appropriate use
Description	D1 prompting; D5 instructions; D4 stakeholder messages
Discernment	D2 evaluation; D7 diagnosis
Diligence	D2 human review; D6 privacy, policy, transparency

ON THE EXAM

Description is not only for Claude. Describing Claude's role clearly to colleagues counts too.

How 4D questions are asked

- **"Which action best reflects Diligence?"** Find the D's verb, then the option that does it.
- **Delegation decides. Description communicates.** Discernment evaluates. Diligence takes responsibility.
- **Distractors borrow another D.** A good checking step is still wrong in a Diligence question if nobody owns it.
- **Sub-part questions:** match product, process or performance to what is being described or judged.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Name the D's verb first. Then eliminate every option that does a different verb.

> A Halden learning designer asks Claude to plan a site-safety course. The plan recommends two-hour sessions "because longer sessions improve retention", then builds the whole schedule on that claim.
>
> She traces how Claude reached the schedule and spots that everything rests on a premise nobody checked.

Which part of the framework is she applying?

A Product discernment

B Process description

C Deployment diligence

D Process discernment

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which part of the framework is she applying?

A Product discernment

Judges the output's quality. She is examining the reasoning behind it.

B Process description

Telling Claude how to work. She is evaluating, not instructing.

C Deployment diligence

Vouching for output before use. Nothing is being shared yet.

D Process discernment

Evaluating how Claude reached its output, and finding a faulty step.

THE SIGNAL

"Traces how Claude reached" means she is judging the reasoning: process, and discernment.

> Halden's marketing lead brainstorms campaign ideas with Claude. Every idea she suggests is praised, including two she already suspects are weak.
>
> She wants Claude to push back and tell her which ideas will not work, and why.

Which change best reflects performance description?

A Specify the campaign's audience, format and length

B Ask Claude to act as a critical sparring partner who challenges weak ideas

C Tell Claude to list ten ideas first, then rank them by cost

D Check each idea she receives against the brand guidelines

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which change best reflects performance description?

A Specify the campaign's audience, format and length

Product description: what the output looks like.

B Ask Claude to act as a critical sparring partner who challenges weak ideas

Defines how Claude behaves in the collaboration: challenging, not supportive.

C Tell Claude to list ten ideas first, then rank them by cost

Process description: the steps Claude follows.

D Check each idea she receives against the brand guidelines

Product discernment: judging output, not describing anything.

THE SIGNAL

The problem was Claude's behaviour as a partner. Performance description fixes behaviour.

> A Halden bid writer used Claude to draft much of a tender response. The client's tender rules require bidders to declare any use of AI tools in preparing a submission.
>
> The response includes service commitments that Halden will be held to.

Which action best reflects Diligence?

A Declare the AI assistance, and have the bid team verify every commitment

B Reword any phrases that sound machine-written, so the question never arises

C Ask Claude to confirm its own draft is accurate, then submit

D Declare the AI assistance, and leave checking to the client's evaluators

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which action best reflects Diligence?

A Declare the AI assistance, and have the bid team verify every commitment

Transparency and deployment diligence together: honest, and owned.

B Reword any phrases that sound machine-written, so the question never arises

Concealment. It breaks the client's rule and transparency diligence.

C Ask Claude to confirm its own draft is accurate, then submit

Claude checking itself is not verification. The commitments are Halden's.

D Declare the AI assistance, and leave checking to the client's evaluators

Honest, but hands responsibility to someone else.

THE SIGNAL

A required declaration plus binding commitments: be honest, and own what you sign.

> Halden's operations director says the weekly service report is "not working" and asks a manager to "get Claude to fix it".
>
> Nobody has agreed what the report is for, who relies on it, or what exactly is wrong with it.

Which first step best reflects Delegation?

A Ask Claude to rewrite last week's report in a more professional tone

B Switch to the most capable model so the rewrite is as strong as possible

C Agree what the report is for and what is wrong, then decide Claude's part

D Ask Claude to review its own previous reports and list their problems

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which first step best reflects Delegation?

A Ask Claude to rewrite last week's report in a more professional tone

Acts before the problem is understood. Tone may not be the issue.

B Switch to the most capable model so the rewrite is as strong as possible

Platform choice before problem awareness. A bigger model fixes nothing unknown.

C Agree what the report is for and what is wrong, then decide Claude's part

Problem awareness first, then task delegation.

D Ask Claude to review its own previous reports and list their problems

Claude cannot know what readers need if nobody has said.

THE SIGNAL

"Nobody has agreed what it is for": problem awareness is missing, so start there.

> Halden HR builds a Project holding the handbook and policy FAQ, with instructions on tone and when to refer people to HR.
>
> Site supervisors then ask it policy questions directly, at any hour, without anyone from HR in the conversation.

Which mode of working with AI is this?

A Automation

B Augmentation

C Agency

D Delegation

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which mode of working with AI is this?

A **Automation**

A set task to set instructions. Here HR is not directing each answer.

B **Augmentation**

A back-and-forth thinking partner. HR is not in the conversation.

C **Agency**

HR shaped knowledge and behaviour in advance; it then serves others alone.

D **Delegation**

A competency, not a mode. It is the decision that led here.

THE SIGNAL

Configured in advance, then working with other people on HR's behalf: agency.

> Halden's customer success team lists four tasks connected to a long-running dispute with a client over missed cleaning visits.
>
> The manager wants to know which task should stay entirely with a person.

Which task is least suitable to delegate to Claude?

A Deciding whether to end the client's contract after the dispute

B Summarising the dispute's email history for the account director

C Turning the last review meeting's notes into an action list

D Drafting three possible wordings for a goodwill letter

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which task is least suitable to delegate to Claude?

A Deciding whether to end the client's contract after the dispute

Costly, hard to reverse, and needs judgement and accountability.

B Summarising the dispute's email history for the account director

Synthesis for a human decision-maker. a strong use of Claude.

C Turning the last review meeting's notes into an action list

Routine restructuring, easily checked against the notes.

D Drafting three possible wordings for a goodwill letter

Options for a person to choose from and edit.

THE SIGNAL

High consequence, hard to undo, needs accountability: the decision stays human.

In five lines

- **AI fluency:** effective, efficient, ethical and safe.
- **Delegation** decides, **Description** communicates, **Discernment** evaluates, **Diligence** takes responsibility.
- **Product, process, performance** - the shared parts of Description and Discernment.
- **Judging quality is Discernment. Owning the consequences is Diligence.**
- **Automation, augmentation, agency:** set task, thinking partner, configured to act alone.

COMING UP

Next: Domain 1 begins. The anatomy of a prompt that works.